
EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

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SECTION 1

INTRODUCTION

This Employee Handbook is designed to acquaint you with the Company and provide you with important information about working conditions, employee benefits, workplace expectations, and the policies and procedures that govern your employment.

The information contained in this Handbook applies to all employees of the Company. Compliance with the policies outlined in this Handbook is a condition of continued employment. However, nothing contained in this Handbook alters an employee's employment status. The contents of this Handbook shall not constitute, nor be construed as, a promise of employment or an employment contract between the Company and any of its employees. This Handbook serves as a general guide to the Company's employment policies, procedures, and workplace standards and is provided for informational purposes only.

Employees are responsible for reading, understanding, and complying with the provisions of this Handbook. Upon joining the Company, every employee is required to acknowledge receipt of this Handbook and confirm that they have read and understood its contents. Our objective is to provide a professional work environment that supports both personal and professional growth through innovation, collaboration, continuous learning, and responsible use of technology. The Company reserves the right to interpret, revise, amend, or discontinue any policy described in this Handbook whenever necessary to meet changing business, operational, or legal requirements. Any changes to the policies contained in this Handbook must be approved by executive management and the Human Resources Department.

MISSION STATEMENT

The Company is an innovative and dynamic technology organization committed to developing secure, intelligent, and responsible digital solutions that empower businesses and individuals to achieve more. We foster innovation, leadership, creativity, collaboration, and critical thinking while maintaining the highest standards of integrity, accountability, customer trust, and technological excellence.

WHO WE ARE

The Company was established to develop innovative software solutions, cloud services, Artificial Intelligence technologies, and cybersecurity platforms that help organizations adapt to an increasingly digital world. Since its founding, the Company has continuously expanded its operations through research, innovation, and strategic investment in emerging technologies, becoming a trusted provider of enterprise technology solutions for organizations across multiple industries.

We are a technology-driven organization that brings together professionals from diverse cultural, educational, and professional backgrounds. Our teams collaborate across software engineering, Artificial Intelligence, cloud computing, cybersecurity, data science, product development, customer success, and business operations to

create secure, reliable, and innovative digital solutions.

The Company promotes an inclusive workplace where diversity of thought, equal opportunity, and mutual respect encourage creativity and continuous improvement. We welcome talented professionals regardless of race, color, religion, national origin, ethnicity, gender, age, disability, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law. We believe that diverse perspectives strengthen innovation and enable us to deliver better products and services to customers worldwide.

WHAT WE BELIEVE

The Company believes that technology should improve people's lives while protecting privacy, strengthening security, and promoting responsible innovation. We are committed to developing products and services that reflect the highest standards of ethics, transparency, accountability, and customer trust.

Our common goal is to create an environment where every employee demonstrates respect for others, professional responsibility, collaboration, and a commitment to continuous learning. We believe that every individual contributes to the success of the organization through integrity, teamwork, innovation, and responsible decision-making. We are committed to providing equal opportunities for all employees and maintaining an inclusive workplace where everyone is encouraged to develop professionally and contribute to the Company's success.

Each year, the Company identifies strategic organizational priorities that guide employee initiatives, professional development programs, and innovation projects. These priorities include Innovation, Customer Success, Integrity, Collaboration, Accountability, Security, Responsible Artificial Intelligence, and Continuous Learning. Together, these values form the foundation of our organizational culture and guide every decision, product, service, and interaction with our colleagues, customers, business partners, and the communities we serve.

Knowledge and Professional Excellence

The purpose of the Company's culture is to develop knowledgeable, innovative, and ethical professionals who are equipped with the skills, experience, and confidence to contribute effectively to organizational success. We strive to create an environment where employees continuously develop both personally and professionally while embracing innovation, collaboration, and responsible leadership.

As part of the Company's strategic vision, executive leadership has established the following core principles to represent our organizational philosophy and long-term objectives.

Organizational Philosophy

Critical Thinking

We encourage employees to analyze information objectively, evaluate evidence carefully, solve complex problems creatively, and make informed decisions based on sound judgment and professional expertise.

Innovation

We promote creativity, originality, and continuous improvement by encouraging employees to explore new ideas, embrace emerging technologies, and develop innovative solutions that create value for our customers and business.

Customer Focus

We are committed to understanding customer needs and delivering products, services, and experiences that exceed expectations. Every decision should contribute to building long-term customer trust and satisfaction.

Collaboration

Through open communication, mutual respect, and teamwork, we build strong relationships across departments and encourage knowledge sharing to achieve common organizational goals.

Continuous Learning

We believe every employee has unique talents and strengths that can be developed through continuous learning, professional training, practical experience, and a commitment to personal growth. We encourage curiosity, adaptability, and lifelong learning as technology continues to evolve.

Diversity and Inclusion

We foster an inclusive workplace where employees from diverse backgrounds, cultures, experiences, and perspectives feel respected, valued, and empowered to contribute to innovation and organizational success.

Professional Development

Employees are encouraged to continuously expand their technical knowledge, leadership capabilities, communication skills, and industry expertise through training programs, certifications, mentoring, and collaborative learning opportunities.

Integrity

We expect every employee to demonstrate honesty, accountability, professionalism, and ethical behavior in every business decision, customer interaction, and workplace activity.

Responsible Artificial Intelligence

We are committed to developing, deploying, and using Artificial Intelligence responsibly. Employees are expected to ensure that AI systems are transparent, secure, fair, privacy-preserving, and subject to appropriate human oversight throughout their lifecycle.

Commitment

We expect every member of the Company to uphold our organizational values, contribute positively to our workplace culture, protect company assets and information, support colleagues, and continuously pursue excellence in everything they do.

SECTION 2

- o EMPLOYEE POLICIES
- o
- o Employee Status Defined
- o
- o An "employee" of the Company is a person who regularly works for the Company on a wage or salary basis. Employees may include exempt, non-exempt, regular full-time, regular part-time, limited-term employees, contractors, and other individuals employed by the Company who are subject to its policies, supervision, and direction in the performance of their duties.
- o
- o Employees of the Company fall into one of the following categories:
- o
- o Executive Management
- o
- o Engineering and Technical Staff
- o
- o Business Operations and Administrative Staff
- o
- o Information Technology and Infrastructure
- o
- o The Human Resources Department is responsible for classifying all employees into one of the following employment classifications for eligibility to receive certain benefits offered by the Company. These classifications are defined as:
- o
- o Exempt: Employees whose positions meet the criteria established under the applicable labor laws and who are exempt from overtime pay requirements.
- o
- o Non-Exempt: Employees whose positions do not meet the applicable exemption criteria and who are eligible to receive overtime compensation in accordance with applicable labor laws for hours worked beyond the standard workweek.
- o
- o Regular Full-Time Employee: An employee who is regularly scheduled to work at least 30 hours per week for an indefinite period or under a full-time employment agreement is classified as a Regular Full-Time Employee.
- o
- o Regular Part-Time Employee: An employee who is regularly scheduled to work fewer than 30 hours per week on an ongoing basis or under a part-time employment agreement is classified as a Regular Part-Time Employee.
- o
- o Limited-Term Employee: When business needs require, the Company may employ individuals on a temporary basis for specific projects or assignments. Limited-Term Employees are hired with the understanding that their employment will conclude upon completion of the assigned project or at the end of a specified period, typically not exceeding three months. Limited-Term Employees do not become Regular Employees solely because of the passage of time, even if they maintain a regular work schedule during their temporary assignment.
- o
- o Regular Full-Time Technical Employee: An employee who regularly works a full-time schedule of at least 30 hours per week within technical departments such as Software Engineering, Artificial Intelligence, Cloud Computing, Cybersecurity, Data Science, Infrastructure, or Product Development. Full-Time Technical Employees are expected to maintain their assigned working schedule, attend required meetings, complete assigned projects, and participate in technical training and collaborative activities.

- o
- o Regular Full-Time Business Employee: An employee who regularly works a full-time schedule within business functions such as Human Resources, Finance, Legal, Sales, Marketing, Customer Success, Operations, or Administration. Employees are expected to be available during established business hours, participate in required meetings and training sessions, and fulfill all responsibilities associated with their position.

Regular Part-Time Technical Employee: An employee who is regularly scheduled to work fewer than 40 hours per week and performs assigned responsibilities on a part-time basis for an indefinite period is referred to as a Regular Part-Time Technical Employee.

Regular Part-Time Business Employee: An employee who regularly works fewer than the standard full-time schedule within business functions such as Human Resources, Finance, Marketing, Customer Success, Operations, or Administration is referred to as a Regular Part-Time Business Employee.

Limited-Term Technical Employee: When business needs require, the Company may hire employees for a temporary period. Limited-Term Technical Employees are hired to work on a specific project or special assignment, with the understanding that such work will be completed within a specified period of time, usually not to exceed three months. Limited-Term Technical Employees do not become Regular Employees solely because of the passage of time, even though they may be regularly scheduled during their temporary assignments.

Contract Employee: Contract Employees may be engaged, as needed, for short-term or project-based assignments depending upon business requirements. Contract Employees are not considered Regular Employees and are not eligible for employee benefits unless otherwise required by applicable law or specified in their contractual agreement.

Equal Opportunity Employer / Non-Discrimination

The Company complies with all applicable federal, state, and local laws regarding equal employment opportunity. We provide equal employment opportunities to all employees and applicants without regard to race, color, religion, sex, age, national origin, citizenship status, disability, genetic information, veteran status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law.

It is the responsibility of all managers and supervisors to ensure that equal consideration is given to every applicant and employee in all employment decisions, including recruitment, hiring, training, promotion, compensation, transfer, discipline, performance evaluation, termination, and all other employment-related actions. Employment decisions are based solely on business needs, qualifications, performance, skills, and merit.

Employees who have questions or concerns regarding discrimination, harassment, or unfair treatment in the workplace are encouraged to report such concerns to their immediate supervisor or the Human Resources Department. Employees may raise concerns in good faith without fear of retaliation. Any employee found to have engaged in unlawful discrimination, harassment, or retaliation will be subject to appropriate disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employment At Will

Employment with the Company is voluntary. Either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment

relationship at any time, with or without notice, and with or without cause, provided such action does not violate applicable federal, state, or local laws.

This Employee Handbook is intended as a general overview of the Company's policies, procedures, and employee benefits. The Company reserves the right to interpret, modify, amend, suspend, or discontinue any policy, benefit, or practice described in this Handbook at any time at its sole discretion.

Corrective Action

Standards of Conduct and Corrective Action

The Company expects every employee to maintain the highest standards of professionalism, ethical conduct, integrity, and accountability while performing their duties. Employees are expected to comply with all Company policies, procedures, and workplace standards. When an employee fails to meet these expectations, the Company expects the employee's manager or supervisor to take appropriate corrective action.

Corrective action within the Company follows a progressive discipline process whenever appropriate. The purpose of corrective action is to help employees improve performance, address policy violations, and maintain a productive and respectful work environment.

The typical sequence of corrective action includes a verbal warning, a written warning, a performance improvement plan (PIP), suspension (with or without pay, as determined by Human Resources and executive management), and, when necessary, termination of employment. In determining the appropriate corrective action, management will consider the seriousness of the violation, the surrounding circumstances, the impact on the business, and the employee's previous performance and disciplinary record.

Although the Company generally follows a progressive disciplinary process, certain violations are considered sufficiently serious to warrant immediate termination of employment. These include, but are not limited to, theft or fraud, insubordination, violence or threats of violence, intentional destruction of Company property, unauthorized access to Company systems or confidential information, serious violations of information security policies, unauthorized disclosure of confidential or proprietary information, falsification of employment records or Company documents, misuse of Company equipment or technology resources, working under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs, harassment or discrimination, conflicts of interest, or any conduct that may damage the Company's reputation, customers, employees, or business operations.

Non-Disclosure / Confidentiality

Protecting confidential business information, intellectual property, and proprietary technology is essential to the Company's success. Employees are expected to safeguard all confidential information obtained during their employment. Confidential information includes, but is not limited to, the following:

Compensation and salary information

Financial reports and business forecasts

Business strategies and marketing plans

Software architecture and system designs

Source code, algorithms, and proprietary technologies

Artificial Intelligence models, datasets, and training materials

Research and development projects

Customer information and customer databases

Employee personnel records

Payroll records

Business contracts and legal documents

Cybersecurity procedures and incident response plans

Internal policies and operational procedures

Cloud infrastructure configurations

Product roadmaps and unreleased features

Pending projects, proposals, and business initiatives

Confidential communications between employees, management, customers, business partners, and vendors

Employees who improperly use, disclose, copy, or distribute confidential or proprietary information will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment, and may also be subject to legal action where permitted by applicable law. This obligation continues even after an employee leaves the Company.

Although employees may engage in outside employment or professional activities where permitted by Company policy, such activities must never create a conflict of interest or compromise an employee's duty of loyalty, confidentiality, or professional responsibilities to the Company.

New Employee Orientation

New Employee Orientation

New Employee Orientation is a formal onboarding process designed to help new employees become familiar with the Company, understand its culture and values, and successfully transition into their new roles. Orientation is coordinated by the Human Resources Department in collaboration with the employee's direct manager and includes an overview of the Company's history, organizational structure, mission, vision, core values, business objectives, and workplace expectations. During the orientation process, new employees will also receive information regarding employee benefits, workplace policies, information security requirements, and complete all required employment documentation. Depending on business needs and the number of new hires, orientation may be conducted individually or as part of a group onboarding program.

Employees will be provided with the equipment, identification badges, access credentials, security procedures, and system permissions necessary to perform their assigned responsibilities, as authorized by their direct manager. The employee's manager will introduce the new employee to colleagues and relevant departments, review the employee's job responsibilities and scope of work, explain the Company's performance evaluation process, and provide guidance on departmental procedures, tools, and work assignments to support a successful transition into the organization.

Probationary Period for New Employees

The probationary period for Regular Full-Time and Regular Part-Time Employees is up to ninety (90) days from the date of hire. During this period, employees have the opportunity to evaluate the Company as a place to work, while management evaluates the employee's performance, skills, conduct, and overall suitability for the position. During the probationary period, either the employee or the Company may terminate the employment relationship at any time, with or without notice, in accordance with applicable law.

Upon completion of the probationary period, the employee's manager may conduct a formal ninety-day performance review. If a formal review is not conducted, the employee will continue employment as a Regular Employee in good standing, subject to all Company policies, procedures, and performance expectations described in this Employee Handbook or communicated by management. Regardless of employment classification or length of service, all employees are expected to maintain the Company's standards of professional conduct, job performance, security, and ethical behavior.

Employee Classifications

Regular/Non-Exempt Employees

The Company's standard business hours are from 8:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., Monday through Friday, unless otherwise determined by departmental requirements or approved flexible work arrangements.

The scheduling of meal periods and rest breaks is coordinated by the employee's direct manager to ensure

appropriate operational coverage and business continuity.

Individual work schedules may be established by the employee's manager or department head based on operational requirements, project deadlines, hybrid or remote work arrangements, business needs, employment classification, and applicable labor regulations. Any variation from an employee's approved work schedule, including additional working hours or schedule adjustments, must receive prior written approval from the employee's direct manager.

The standard work schedule for Non-Exempt Employees consists of eight (8) paid working hours per day, excluding an unpaid meal period, together with authorized rest breaks in accordance with applicable labor laws. Overtime work exceeding forty (40) hours during a workweek must be approved in advance by the employee's direct manager. Approved overtime will be compensated in accordance with applicable federal, state, and local employment laws.

Administrators and Other Exempt Employees

Exempt employees work a schedule which may fluctuate depending on the nature of the work and the demands of particular projects. Exempt employees are not paid on an hourly basis, but it is presumed that full-time exempt employees work an average of at least 40 hours per week (or more as specified by individual contract), excluding lunch breaks, and part-time employees work an average of at least the prorated portion of their assignment (i.e., a half-time exempt employee would average at least 20 hours per week). Exempt employees do not receive overtime pay. Although exempt employees are not paid by the hour, particular assignments may require regular attendance during specific hours.

Teachers

Teachers are expected to work time as needed to fulfill their responsibilities to students, parents and the responsibilities as outlined in their contract, job description and in this Employee Manual which may require them to work beyond the calendar work year and work day.

Full-time K8 teachers are expected to be on campus a minimum of 8 hours and 40 minutes per school day, including a 40-minute duty-free lunch period when possible, regardless of the actual classroom schedule.

Full-time pre-school teachers are expected to be on campus for the entire day's pre-school schedule, as published. Teachers who leave the building during their lunch period must notify the receptionist at departure and upon their return.

Teachers are assigned specific schedules for teaching and supervision but are expected to be available, as part of their contract, for pre and/or after school meetings and assignments, including, but not limited to, parent-teacher meetings, program assignments, supervisory assignments such as lunch-time duties, and school programs in which their students participate.

Arrival and dismissal duties are shared by faculty and are not included as a period of supervisory responsibility.

Full-time K8 teachers will be given, when possible, two preparation periods daily, one of which may be assigned for meetings.

Part-time teachers are expected to follow the same standards and be in school and available for duty assignment and/or meetings for the hours they are required to be on campus. For example, if a part-time teacher is paid on an 80% basis, teaching responsibilities and time on campus are pro-rated on an 80% basis.

All teachers in all classifications, including pre-school teachers, limited term and substitutes, regardless of being full-time or part-time, are expected to 1) be on campus and available for teacher responsibilities a minimum of 20 minutes before their first scheduled duty or class and remain on campus and available a minimum of 20 minutes after their last scheduled duty or class and 2) participate in all school sponsored professional development/in-service workdays and programs applicable to their teaching assignments

Personnel Files

Employee personnel files include the following: job application, job description, résumé, records of participation in training events, salary history, benefit enrollment forms, records of disciplinary action and documents related to employee performance reviews, coaching, and mentoring. All medical information, including medical reports, notes, etc. are kept separately as per federal law.

Personnel files are the property of Levine Academy, and access to the information is restricted. Management personnel of Levine Academy who have a legitimate reason to review the file are allowed to do so. Employees who wish to review their own file should contact their supervisor or Human Resources. With reasonable advance notice, the employee may review his/her personnel file in the School's office and in the presence of their supervisor or Human Resources.

Personnel Data Changes

It is the responsibility of each employee to promptly notify their direct manager and the Human Resources Department of any changes in personnel information, including but not limited to:

- Mailing address*
- Telephone number(s)*
- Name and number of dependents*
- Emergency contact information*
- Legal name changes*
- Changes in work authorization or employment eligibility, where applicable*

Employee personnel records must remain accurate and up to date at all times. Maintaining current information enables the Company to administer employee benefits, payroll, emergency communications, and other employment-related matters effectively.

Employee Performance Review and Planning Sessions

Managers will conduct performance reviews and career development discussions with all Regular Full-Time and Regular Part-Time Employees on an annual basis. Managers may also conduct informal performance discussions, coaching sessions, or project evaluations throughout the year whenever appropriate.

Performance reviews provide an opportunity for employees and managers to discuss current responsibilities, recognize achievements, evaluate performance, identify strengths, and establish meaningful objectives for continued professional development. Together, employees and managers will identify opportunities to improve performance, develop new technical and professional skills, and support career growth within the Company.

Career development discussions also provide an opportunity to establish future goals, identify learning opportunities, discuss leadership development, and create individual development plans that align both employee aspirations and organizational objectives.

The Company reserves the right to implement hiring freezes, salary freezes, or other workforce management measures whenever business, operational, or financial conditions require.

Salary adjustments, bonuses, and compensation reviews are not automatically tied to annual performance evaluations. Compensation decisions are based on multiple factors, including individual performance, market conditions, business performance, internal equity, available budget, and the Company's overall financial position.

Outside Employment

Employees may engage in outside employment or professional activities provided that:

- The outside employment does not interfere with the employee's responsibilities or job performance.*
- The outside employment does not create an actual or potential conflict of interest with the Company.*
- The outside employment does not violate the terms of the employee's employment agreement, confidentiality obligations, or any applicable Company policy.*
- The employee continues to meet all performance expectations and responsibilities associated with their position.*

Unless an alternative work schedule has been approved by management, employees remain responsible for meeting the Company's scheduling requirements regardless of any outside employment commitments.

Employees may not use Company time, facilities, equipment, software, networks, confidential information, intellectual property, or other Company resources for outside employment or personal business activities without prior written authorization.

Employees must continue to comply with all confidentiality, intellectual property, duty of loyalty, and non-compete obligations while engaging in any approved outside employment. Where appropriate, employees may be required to disclose outside employment to the Human Resources Department or their direct manager to ensure that no conflict of interest exists.

Employment Termination

Termination of employment is an inevitable part of personnel activity within any organization, and many of the reasons for termination are routine. Below are a few examples of some of the most common circumstances under which employment is terminated.

Resignation – voluntary employment termination initiated by an employee.

Termination – involuntary employment termination initiated by Levine Academy.

Layoff – involuntary employment termination initiated by Levine Academy for non-disciplinary reasons.

When a non-exempt employee intends to terminate his/her employment with Levine Academy, he/she shall give Levine Academy at least two (2) weeks written notice. Exempt employees shall give at least four (4) weeks written notice.

Since employment with Levine Academy is based on mutual consent, both the employee and Levine Employee's benefits will be affected by employment termination in the following manner. All vested benefits that are due and payable at termination will be paid. Some benefits may be continued at the employee's expense (See Section 6, Benefits and Services) if the employee elects to do so. The employee will be notified of the benefits that may be continued and of the terms, conditions, and limitations. Levine Academy, as a religious organization, has been granted exemption from the Texas Workforce Commissions unemployment program. All requests for unemployment benefits will be denied by the Texas Workforce Commission.

List of Actions and Conduct that may be Grounds for Immediate Termination

Theft or inappropriate removal or possession of property; Falsification of timekeeping records; Working under the influence of alcohol or illegal drugs; Possession, distribution, solicitation, sale, transfer, or use of alcohol or illegal drugs in the workplace:

- o Fighting or threatening violence in the workplace;
- o Boisterous or disruptive activity in the workplace;
- o Negligence or improper conduct leading to damage of School-owned or customer-owned property;
- o Insubordination or other disrespectful conduct;
- o Violation of safety or health rules;
- o Smoking in the workplace including e-cigarettes;
- o Sexual or other unlawful or unwelcomed harassment (See Section 4.3, Harassment, Including Sexual Harassment);
- o Unauthorized use of telephones, or other School-owned equipment.

Using School equipment for purposes other than business (i.e. playing games on computers or personal Internet usage);

Unauthorized disclosure of business "secrets" or confidential information; Violation of personnel policies; and Unsatisfactory performance or conduct.

Health-Related Issues

An employee who becomes aware of any health-related issue, including pregnancy, should notify their supervisor and Human Resources of one's health status. This policy has been instituted strictly to protect the employee. Prior to returning to work following a long-term absence that is health-related, a written "permission to work" from the employee's doctor is required before the employee may resume work. The doctor's note should specify whether the employee is able to perform regular duties as outlined in his/her job description.

A leave of absence may be granted on a case-by-case basis. If the need arises for a leave of absence, employees should notify their supervisor and Human Resources.

Building Security

All employees who are issued keys to the office are responsible for their safekeeping. The last employee, or a designated employee, who leaves the office at the end of the business day assumes the responsibility to ensure that all doors are securely locked, the alarm system is armed, thermostats are set on appropriate evening and/or weekend setting, and all appliances and lights are turned off with exception of the lights normally left on for security purposes. Employees are not allowed on School property after hours without prior authorization from the Head of School. Employees found to be sharing keys, alarm codes or badges are subject to disciplinary procedures up to and including possible termination. Should an employee have need for a key, alarm code or badge the employee should contact Human Resources immediately.

Insurance on Personal Effects

All employees should be sure that their own personal insurance policies cover the loss of anything occasionally left at the office. Levine Academy assumes no risk for any loss or damage to personal property whether in the building or in the parking lot. Employees should be diligent in securing any personal property and ensuring they remained in locked areas at all times.

Texas Law Regarding Child Abuse and Neglect

Child abuse and neglect are against the law in Texas, and so is the failure to report it. Abuse is defined as mental, emotional, physical, or sexual injury to a child or failure to prevent such injury to a child.

Anyone who suspects a child has been abused or mistreated is required to report it to the Texas Department of Family Services (TDFS) or to a law enforcement agency as soon as possible, but no later than 48 hours before bruises and marks start to fade. The report can be made using the Abuse and Neglect Hotline (1- 800-252-5400). Your report to TDFS is confidential and not subject to public release under the Open Records Act. The law provides immunity from civil or criminal liability for innocent persons who report even unfounded suspicions, as long as the report is made in good faith. Your identity is kept confidential.

Any employee suspecting child abuse or neglect is expected to use the following procedure:

Any information about the relationship between the child and the suspected abuser.

1. Do not confront the suspected abuser or molester
2. Report the details to your supervisor immediately, including notes of the following:
 - a. All incidents and observations, including dates and times;
 - b. Any information about the relationship between the child and the suspected abuser
 - c. Pertinent information that TDFS will need for its investigation:
 - i. Name, age, and address of the child
 - ii. Current injuries, medical problems, or behavioral problems
 - iii. Parents' names and names of siblings at home
3. The supervisor will then notify the Head of School of the report. Human Resources should be consulted should the claim involve any employee of Ann & Nate Levine Academy.
4. Maintain confidentiality. Information about the suspected child abuse is only to be given out or discussed on a "need to know" basis and is not to be shared with fellow employees, parents, students, or anyone outside the school other than law enforcement.
5. Make report to TDFS or local law enforcement and let them investigate. This will normally be done by the Head of School or his/her designee.

Procedure for Handling Employee Complaints

Under normal working conditions, employees who have a job-related problem, question or complaint should first discuss it with their immediate supervisor. At this level, employees usually reach the simplest, quickest, and most satisfactory solution. If the employee and supervisor do not solve the problem, Levine Academy encourages employees to contact Human Resources.

Whistleblower and Retaliation Policy

A whistleblower as defined by this policy is an employee of Ann and Nate Levine Academy who reports an activity that he or she considers to be illegal or dishonest to one or more of the parties specified in this policy. The whistleblower is not responsible for investigating the activity or for determining fault or corrective measures; appropriate management officials are charged with these responsibilities. Examples of illegal or dishonest activities are violations of federal, state or local laws; billing for services not performed; and other fraudulent financial reporting.

If an employee has knowledge of or a concern of illegal or dishonest fraudulent activity, the employee is to contact his or her supervisor, Human Resources, the Controller, the Head of School or Board President. The employee must exercise sound judgment to avoid baseless allegations. An employee who intentionally files a false report of wrongdoing will be subject to corrective action up to and including discharge.

Whistleblower protections are provided in two important areas -- confidentiality and against retaliation. Insofar as possible, the confidentiality of the whistleblower will be maintained. However, identity may have to be disclosed to conduct a thorough investigation, to comply with the law and to provide accused individuals their legal rights of defense. The school will not retaliate against a whistleblower. This includes, but is not limited to, protection from retaliation in the form of an adverse employment action such as discharge, compensation decreases, or poor work assignments and threats of physical harm.

Any whistleblower who believes he or she is being retaliated against must contact Human Resources, the Controller or Head of School immediately. The right of a whistleblower for protection against retaliation does not include immunity for any personal wrongdoing that is alleged and investigated.

Employees with any questions regarding this policy should contact Human Resources.

Workplace Solicitation Policy

All employees will be solicited occasionally for fundraising campaigns during the school year. Participation in fundraisers is encouraged but will in no way impact employment reviews or ongoing employment with Ann and Nate Levine Academy.

Literary Property

Materials prepared by educational staff members on assignment or incidental to it and published or released by Ann and Nate Levine Academy are the property of Levine Academy. Individuals engaged by Levine Academy to prepare texts or instructional materials have no property rights to the work product unless a written agreement with Levine Academy, signed by the Head of School, explicitly provides for such rights.

The copyright to literary or educational material prepared by an educational staff member may be retained by the employee only if the material was conceived and produced by the employee (or at the employee's direction) outside of the employee's duties, scope, and hours of employment.

SECTION 3 DAILY OPERATIONAL POLICIES & PROCEDURES

Supplies; Expenditures; Obligor Levine Academy

Only authorized persons may purchase supplies in the name of Levine Academy. No employee whose regular duties do not include purchasing shall incur any expense on behalf of Levine Academy or bind Levine Academy by any promise or representation without written approval.

Expense Reimbursement

Expenses incurred by an employee must have prior approval by a supervisor. Levine Academy is a non-profit organization and does not pay sales tax nor can it reimburse for sales tax. Most vendors will require a sales tax exemption certificate which is available in the accounting office. All reimbursement requests will be delivered to the Financial Department and accompany both the approved form for reimbursement as well as any applicable receipts. The Financial Department will reimburse based on their approved time frame, the employee should communicate with that department as to the expected reimbursement period. Reimbursements are not to be included in an employee's paycheck.

Parking

Employees are prohibited from parking their cars in the first two parking rows, unless permission is granted from the Head of School for a specified reason. Levine Academy Security Officer(s) may approach the employee to request they move their car, the Officer may turn the employee's car information in to Human Resources or, in repeat offender cases, the Officer may, with the knowledge and consent of Human Resources, have the car towed off the property.

Visitors

To better protect the safety and security of employees and students as well as Levine Academy property and facilities, only authorized visitors are allowed on school property. Restricting unauthorized visitors helps to maintain safety standards, safeguard employee and student welfare, protect equipment and confidential information against theft, and reduce potential distractions and disturbances.

For safety and security reasons, the school discourages employees' family and friends from visiting. If an employee has a visitor, he or she will be asked to meet that person at the school reception desk.

All visitors should enter Levine Academy and report to the Greeter's desk in the Main Entrance. Once authorized, visitors will receive directions or be escorted to their destination. Employees who have outside visitors are responsible for their conduct and must take steps to ensure their safety. All visitors must sign in and sign out in order to maintain an accurate listing of who is located on premises at all times, in the event of an emergency.

If employees see an unauthorized person on school premises, they should notify their supervisor or Human Resources immediately or direct the individual to the reception area. All guests are required to wear a Visitor's tag while on campus.

Immigration Law Compliance

Levine Academy employs only United States citizens and those non-U.S. citizens authorized to work in the United States in compliance with the Immigration Reform and Control Act of 1986. Each new employee, as a condition of employment, must complete the Employment Eligibility Verification Form I-9 and present documentation establishing identity and employment eligibility. Former employees who are rehired must also complete the form. Under no circumstances will a contract be valid should the proper documents of Employment Eligibility not be available. It is against law to create, accept or enter into any agreement with which an applicant is allowed to work prior to producing the proper documents. All contracts must be reviewed by Human Resources prior to being valid.

Hiring of Relatives

Selection, assignment and appraisal of every employee should be as objective as possible. Where relatives are involved, it is difficult to appear objective, even under the most desirable situations. Therefore, Levine Academy will only hire relatives of current employees if the new employee works in a different department than the current employee. The school will not hire, promote or transfer a relative into a supervisor/subordinate relationship under any circumstances. For the purposes of this policy, "relative" means spouse, parent, and child.

Relatives considered for employment with the school must meet all job qualifications, and additionally, such hiring requires the prior approval of the Head of School. The Head of School reserves the right to accept relative assignments on a temporary or seasonal basis.

External Communications

The Head of School is the official spokesperson for Levine Academy. Employees who receive a request from the news media for information (whether written or oral) or for an interview relating to the school or its business, should directly refer the inquiry to the Head of School or the designated administrator. Any appearance on behalf of Levine Academy or public comments about the school by others requires the advance approval of the Head of School.

Solicitation and Distribution

Levine Academy wants every employee to work in an environment free from unnecessary and inappropriate distractions. Solicitation by an employee of another employee is prohibited during the working time of either person. Working time is defined as time when an employee's duties require that he/she be engaged in work tasks. Employees are prohibited from selling merchandise, requesting financial contributions, distributing any pamphlets or literature not related to your job, or any other type of solicitation or distribution not related to your job, without prior approval from the Head of School. This includes the unauthorized posting of bulletins, notices or advertisements on school bulletin boards, or on any other school means.

Conflict of Interest

An actual or potential conflict of interest occurs when an employee is in a position to influence a decision that may result in a personal gain for that employee or for a relative as a result of business dealings with Levine Academy. For the purposes of this policy, we define a relative as any person who is related by blood or marriage, or whose relationship with the employee is similar to that of persons who are related by blood or marriage. There is no "presumption of guilt" created by the mere existence of a relationship with outside firms. However, if you have any influence on transactions involving purchases, contracts, or leases, it is imperative that you disclose this fact to the Head of School as soon as possible. By alerting us to the existence of any actual or even a potential conflict of interest, we can establish safeguards to protect all parties. The potential for personal gain is not limited to situations where an employee or relative has a significant ownership in a firm with which Levine Academy does business. Personal gains can also result from situations where an employee or relative receives a kickback, bribe, substantial gift, or special consideration as a result of a transaction or business dealings involving Levine Academy.

Attendance / Punctuality

Levine Academy expects that every employee will be regular and punctual in attendance. This means being in the office, ready to work, at their starting time each day. Absenteeism and tardiness places a burden on other employees and on the school.

If you are unable to report for work for any reason, you must notify your supervisor as soon as possible. You are responsible for speaking directly with your supervisor about your absence. It is not acceptable to leave a

message on a supervisor's voice mail or to send an email, except in extreme emergencies. In the case of leaving a voice-mail message, a follow-up call must be made later that day. Levine Academy phone number is 972-248-3032. Upon return to work fill out an absence report which must be submitted and approved by your supervisor or you will be docked for the absence regardless of any available sick time, personal time or vacation that you have available.

All faculty at Levine Academy must arrange for a substitute teacher when they are absent from school. Only approved substitute teachers may be used. A list of approved substitute teachers is available from the Department's assistants.

Should undue tardiness become apparent, disciplinary action may be required.

Absence Without Notice

When you are unable to work due to illness or an accident, please notify your supervisor. This will allow the school to arrange for temporary coverage of your duties, and helps other employees to continue work in your absence. Upon return to work an Employee Absence Report must be submitted and signed by your supervisor or you will be docked for the absence regardless of any available sick time, personal time or vacation that you have available. If you do not report for work and the school is not notified of your status, it will be assumed after two consecutive days of absence that you have resigned, and you will be removed from the payroll.

If you become ill while at work or must leave the office for some other reason before the end of the workday, be sure to inform your supervisor of the situation and check out with the greeter.

Harassment, Including Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment training is not required under federal law. However, many states have enacted legislation specifically requiring sexual harassment training. Even if not required in a state in which you operate, the Supreme Court's landmark decisions in the 1998 Faragher and Ellerth sexual harassment cases, subsequent court decisions and EEOC Guidelines make it clear that sexual harassment training is essential. To raise a defense or avoid punitive damages in sexual harassment lawsuits, employers need to show that they have provided periodic sexual harassment training to all employees.

Supervisors must immediately report to Human Resources any complaint received from an employee who is alleging harassment or who is reporting a fellow employee's harassment. Likewise, any employee who believes he/she has been the object of harassment may report the matter directly to Human Resources.

The following sections—Community Expectation; Community Standard; Reporting Incidents; plus definitions in the area of misconduct and discrimination—are included as well in our All School Handbook. Any misconduct outlined below, and the consequences of such behavior, apply to both employee and student at Levine Academy.

Community Expectation: A Positive Learning Environment

Levine Academy encourages a positive learning environment and the fulfillment of the school's mission. Employees have the right to work in an environment that is supportive and safe, and students have the right to develop academically, spiritually and socially in a safe environment. The Ethical Covenant [found on pp. 8-9 of this All School Handbook] ensures each child enjoys the daily experiences provided by the Levine Academy community.

Our aim is for employees and students to exemplify good citizenship on campus and while away from school. Regarding students, Levine's instructional approach, which can include elements from both Conscious Discipline and Responsibility-Centered Discipline, seeks to develop each student's conduct and citizenship. If necessary,

for students, the school's intervention may include verbal warnings, parent notification, loss of privileges, the assignment of academic or counseling obligation, and/or a conference with the Principal or Head of School. Severe or excessive incidents will result in detention, suspension or expulsion. For employees, consequences for misconduct may include one or more of the following: verbal warning from one's supervisor or the Head of School, written documentation in one's personnel file, leave of absence without pay, non-renewal of one's annual contract, or termination of employment.

Community Standard: Respect for Others

Levine Academy is committed to its Mission of being a dynamic, inclusive Jewish day school. In 2019, the school adopted its Inclusivity Declarations, which begins with the statement: 'Levine Academy's commitment to diversity is all-encompassing: we seek to embrace all facets of human differences within our student population—gender, race, nationality, socio-economic, learning traits, physical traits, family profiles, Jewish beliefs, and all other manners in which our families self-identify. This level of inclusivity is a natural by-product of Levine's Middot.'

Disrespect of any person violates our Community Standard and has no place within the Levine community. Levine prohibits all forms of Discriminatory Misconduct, Physical Misconduct, Sexual Misconduct, Child Abuse, and Adult-Student Boundary Crossing; and will take disciplinary action against those engaged in any of these behaviors. Some of these School policies are also prohibited by local, state, and federal law and Levine will cooperate fully with these laws, including any mandatory reporting requirements, such as those for Child Abuse and Sexual Assault.

Reporting Incidents

Levine encourages all members of its community to report any incident involving these types of misconduct to a School Administrator without delay—students must report a matter to a teacher, and administrator, or the Head of School; employees must report a matter to the HR Director or to the Head of School. Levine Academy will respond promptly and equitably to all reports. Retaliating against a person who is involved in any way with reporting or resolving a complaint is prohibited. An individual found to have violated any of these policies is subject to the School's application of its Community Standards and Policies, with possible consequences including, but not limited, to disciplinary action, such as mandatory evaluation, counseling, community service, educational requirements, suspension, dismissal, or expulsion.

If a student feels s/he is a victim of discrimination, harassment, bullying, cyber-bullying, intimidation or menacing, s/he should talk immediately with a teacher, advisor, counselor, Principal or the Head of School. The student should speak with whomever he or she feels most comfortable. If the student does not feel comfortable talking with any of the above alone, s/he should bring a friend or write a note. Levine Academy encourages the student to talk with a parent or other adult whom s/he trusts so the parent or other adult can also provide assistance.

If an employee feels s/he is a victim of discrimination, harassment, bullying, cyber-bullying, intimidation or menacing, s/he should talk immediately with the HR Director or the Head of School.

School Jurisdiction

- Levine Academy expects its students, faculty, and staff to exemplify good citizenship on campus and away from school.
- The school reserves the right to hold students and employees accountable for actions that reflect badly on the school or jeopardize the safety or well-being of other students or employees, even if the actions occur off campus at a non-school event.
- Parents are expected to monitor their children's events occurring away from school to ensure the well-being of all participants. This policy includes behavior at Bar/Bat Mitzvah services and parties.

Technology Misconduct

- Any type of communication that results in distraction/disruption in the school environment, even if the communication originally occurred off campus and/or not during school hours, will result in a school consequence.
- This policy includes, but is not limited to, online communities such as Facebook and YouTube.
- This policy includes email, cell phones, cyber-bullying, texting or any other technology misconduct.

Examples of Discriminatory Misconduct

Examples of behaviors that may be considered Discriminatory Misconduct include, but are not limited to the following:

- Excluding or threatening to exclude someone from a group or social activity based on any identifiers listed above
- Teasing someone based on any of identifiers listed above
- Treating someone differently based on any of the identifier listed above
- Making slurs, jokes, comments, or other offensive conduct
- Using a derogatory term for a person or group
- Using symbols of oppression or degradation
- Using hurtful language, gestures, or images
- Mocking or harmfully imitating another person or group
- Sending threatening or hurtful messages through email, text, or social media
- Ridiculing or gossiping about someone via any means
- Creating email or social media accounts to harm someone based on any identifiers above
- Inappropriately identifying someone by a characteristic rather than their name

Explanations and Definitions of Discriminatory Misconduct

Harassment

Harassment is unwelcome or uncomfortable conduct that is based on race, color, national origin, age, religion, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, veteran status, disability, or genetic information. It is offensive to a reasonable person and has the purpose or effect of interfering with an individual's work or educational performance. Harassment creates an abusive, hostile, or intimidating environment for work or learning.

Hate Speech

Hate Speech is any form of communication expressing hate or encouraging violence towards a person or group, often based on any of the identifiers above.

Bias

Bias is disproportionate treatment of a person, group, concept, or object based on any of the identifiers above. It can be for or against an entity, and is often based on prejudice, close-mindedness, or unfair opinions. Bias can be overt or covert; and may be innate or learned.

Sexual Identity, Gender Identity and Gender Expression Discrimination

Sexual Identity, Gender Identity and Gender Expression Discrimination is when a person treats another person unfairly or disrespectfully because of their sexual identity, gender identity or gender expression.

Bullying and Cyber-Bullying

Bullying is any physically or psychologically harmful behavior based on the action of someone who has greater power based on their status or privilege over someone who has less power, often related to the identifiers above. Bullying can be deliberate or unconscious; and does not have to be repeated, intentional or severe to violate this

policy. Cyber-bullying is when someone uses technology to harass, threaten, demean, embarrass, target, isolate or otherwise cause harm to another person, group, or organization.

Relational Aggression

Relational aggression is behavior intended to harm, or threatens to harm, others through deliberate manipulation of their social standing and relationships. Relational aggression may be direct or covert; and it may be either planned or in response to, another person or group's actions. It may be directed at a peer, peer group or a potential or actual romantic partner.

Emotional Aggression

Emotional aggression is harmful behavior directed at others, often driven by impulsive emotions, and occurring with little forethought or intent. It can be the result of negative emotions, including anger, and is not intended to create any positive outcomes. Examples of emotional aggression include, but are not limited to, yelling, teasing, threatening, and other intimidating behavior.

Hazing

Hazing is any activity by which a person endangers or threatens to endanger, the physical safety or emotional health of another for purposes of initiation or admission into or affiliation with any group or organization. Hazing includes, but is not limited to, forced and prolonged physical activity; forced consumption of any food, beverage, medication or controlled substance, whether or not prescribed, in excess of the usual amounts for human consumption, or forced consumption of any substance not generally intended for human consumption; and prolonged deprivation of sleep, food, or drink.

The School's Response to Reports of Misconduct

Upon receipt of such complaint from a student, the counselor, principal or Head of School will investigate the complaint completely and, if and when appropriate, will take action based on the circumstances. Action may include education, counseling, suspension, or dismissal. To the extent possible and allowed by law, Levine Academy will maintain confidentiality within the confines of the investigation of the alleged prohibited behavior. All parties are treated with dignity and Levine Academy will not retaliate against anyone for making a report or serving as a witness.

Upon receipt of such complaint from an employee, the HR Director and/or the Head of School will investigate the complaint completely and, if and when appropriate, will take action based on the circumstances. For employees, consequences for misconduct may include one or more of the following: verbal warning from one's supervisor or the Head of School, written documentation in one's personnel file, leave of absence without pay, non-renewal of one's annual contract, or termination of employment.

Substance Abuse

Levine Academy is committed to providing a safe and productive workplace for its employees. In keeping with this commitment, the following rules regarding alcohol and drugs of abuse have been established for all staff members, regardless of rank or position, including both regular and temporary employees. The rules apply during working hours to all employees of Levine Academy while they are on School premises or elsewhere on School business.

The manufacturing, distribution, solicitation, possession, sale, or purchase of controlled substances of abuse on School property is prohibited. Being under the influence of illegal drugs, alcohol, or substances of abuse on School property is prohibited. Working while under the influence of prescription drugs that impair performance is prohibited.

So that there are no questions about what these rules signify, please note the following definitions:

Drug paraphernalia: Equipment, a product, or material that is used or intended for use in concealing an illegal drug, or otherwise introducing into the human body an illegal drug or controlled substance.

Illegal drug: Any drug or derivative thereof whose use, possession, sale, transfer, attempted sale or transfer, manufacture, or storage is illegal or regulated under any federal, state, or local law or regulation. Any drug, including – but not limited to – a prescription drug, used for any reason other than that prescribed by a physician.

Inhalants used illegally.

Under the influence: A state of not having the normal use of mental or physical faculties resulting from the voluntary introduction into the body of an alcoholic beverage, drug, or substance of abuse.

School property: All School owned or leased property used by employees.

Controlled substance of abuse: Any substance listed in Schedules I-V of Section 202 of the Controlled Substance Act, as amended.

Drug: Any chemical substance that produces physical, mental, emotional, or behavioral change in the user.

Consistent with the rules listed above, any of the following actions constitutes a violation of Levine Academy's policy on drugs and may subject an employee to disciplinary action, up to and including immediate termination.

Using, selling, purchasing, transferring, manufacturing, or storing an illegal drug or drug paraphernalia, or attempting to or assisting another to do so, while in the course of employment.

Working or reporting to work, conducting School business or being on School property while under the influence of an illegal drug or alcohol, or in an impaired condition.

Tobacco Products

The use of tobacco products, including the use of electronic cigarettes, is not permitted anywhere on Levine Academy's premises.

Telephone Use

Levine Academy's telephones are intended for the use of serving our students and in conducting Levine Academy's business. Personal usage during business hours is discouraged except for extreme emergencies. All personal telephone calls should be kept brief to avoid congestion on the telephone line. To respect the rights of all employees and avoid miscommunication in the office, employees must inform family members and friends to limit personal telephone calls during working hours.

If an employee is found to be deviating from this policy, he/she will be subject to disciplinary action.

Public Image

Levine Academy employees are expected to dress as role models for our students and in accordance with our Jewish tradition's rules of modesty. During school hours or whenever representing Levine Academy, you are expected to present a clean, neat, and tasteful appearance. You should always dress and groom yourself according to the requirements of your position, accepted social standards and the guidelines below.

Teachers and employees working in office areas should always dress conservatively and professionally. Loose fitting, modest clothing should always be the general standard. Skirts and blouses, dresses and dress slacks are acceptable. Sleeveless attire is acceptable but thin straps are not acceptable. Men are expected to wear dress

shirts. Jeans are acceptable for teachers in the Early Childhood Center and Kindergarten. For all others, jeans are never appropriate attire unless special permission is given in advance by the Head of School.

During summer break the office is in summer casual mode.

Employees involved with outdoor school activities may wear more casual clothing as directed by their supervisor. Long hair must be tied back to ensure employees' personal safety. Loose clothing or dangling jewelry that poses a safety hazard to employees is also prohibited.

Uniforms are provided for employees who work in certain positions. Uniformed employees must wear neat and clean uniforms and safe, clean and well maintained shoes at all times.

For all employees, professional appearance also means that the school expects you to maintain good hygiene and grooming while working. Facial hair is permitted as long as it is neat and well-trimmed. Earrings are acceptable. Rings through the nose, eyebrow, tongue, or body parts (other than the ear lobe) visible to the public may not be worn while working. All tattoos must be small in size or covered at all times and may not be offensive in nature.

Levine Academy reserves the right to determine appropriate dress at all times and in all circumstances and may send employees home to change clothes should it be determined their dress is not appropriate. Employees will not be compensated for this time away from work.

Your supervisor is responsible for maintaining a reasonable dress code appropriate to the job you perform. Be sure to consult your supervisor if you have questions as to what constitutes appropriate appearance. We may, when necessary, make reasonable accommodation in this policy for a person with a disability.

Consult your supervisor if you have any questions about appropriate business attire.

KASHRUT Policy

Kashrut, the Jewish dietary laws, is one of the pillars of Jewish practice and life. *Kashrut* is one of the most significant ways of making our behaviors *kadosh* – holy. Judaism teaches that our basic drives are neither holy nor unholy, but they are waiting to be holy, and by our thought, intention, and our ability to make moral distinctions we can make all of our acts holy – even the way we eat.

Levine Academy serves students across the entire spectrum of religious observance and Kashrut practices vary from family to family. While we completely respect each of our family's personal observance and spirituality at home, we maintain a standard of Kashrut that is inclusive of all our Levine Families.

The Torah defines the following characteristics as kosher foods:

1. Animals--Kosher animals chew their cud and have split hoofs.
2. Poultry—The Torah simply provides a list of birds that are kosher and not kosher.
3. Fish—Fish that is kosher has fins and scales. Shellfish are not kosher.
4. Meat--Milk and meat/poultry products may not be served together and dairy may not be eaten immediately after eating meat. Levine Academy follows the tradition of three hours between eating meat followed by milk.

Personal Lunches and Snacks:

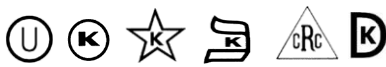
In order to preserve our high standard of Kashrut with ease, we simply ask that any food brought from home contain no meat.

1. Food may only be brought into school from a Kosher supervised restaurant or items may be purchased from a grocery store if the item contains a hechsher symbol.
2. All Food from home or from a kosher restaurant must be either Parve or Dairy. (not meat)
3. Do to personal levels of Kashrut observance, as well as allergies, no child is to share their lunch or snacks with others.

Shared or Distributed Foods

Food brought to school for distribution to students other than your own child must be certified as kosher. Furthermore, all food served after lunch must be exclusively PAREVE certified kosher with no meat nor dairy.

Kosher Symbols: Symbols of kosher certification on food packaging are known as a hechsher. Examples of kosher symbols are:



The package needs contain a recognized Kosher symbol and not just a K.

Foods that Do Not Require a Kosher Symbol (hechsher)

Beverages

- Milk – Plain only
- Soda
- Fruit Juices – (grape products need a hechsher) No artificial or “natural” flavors or colors

Fruits and Vegetables

- Canned Fruits and vegetables – *No artificial or “natural” flavors or colors
- Fresh Fruits and Vegetables
- Dried Fruits and Vegetables – Domestic only and without added flavors

What is the Deal with Fish?

Fish is considered pareve according to the Kashrut – it is considered neither meat nor dairy. Kosher fish are those with fins and scales, such as tuna, salmon, trout, and halibut.

Where you can find kosher certified foods?

1. Tom Thumb, (1380 W. Campbell) Coit & Campbell Roads.
2. Tom Thumb, (11920 Preston Road) Preston & Forest Roads.

Technology and Communication

Any device or computer including, but not limited to, desk phones, cell phones, tablets, laptops, desktop computers, and iPads that Levine Academy provides for your use, should only be used for school business and for students as a learning tool. These items are the property of Levine Academy. The setup and installation of all hardware, operating systems and software is the sole responsibility of the school's IT department. Cell phones are not to be used in the classroom during instruction or while supervising children; the only exception for cell phone usage during the academic day would be for supervisor-approved school projects.

E-mail and Voice Mail

At Levine Academy electronic mail and telephone voice mail are efficient and valuable tools. They are also property of the school. In short, neither of these systems is considered to be confidential, nor should they be used to meet an employee's own personal needs.

The rule of thumb when it comes to e-mail and voice mail is that employees should not say or write anything they would not want someone other than the intended receiver to hear or read. Remember that even when an e-mail or voice mail message has been deleted from a location, it is still possible to retrieve and read that message.

Levine Academy reserves the right to access and read any and all information contained in computers, computer files, e-mail messages, or voice mail messages. Employees should have no expectation of privacy with regard to these communications. Employees will be in violation of the school's discrimination and harassment policy if they send, receive, or access discriminatory, harassing, or otherwise inappropriate e-mails or voice mails.

System and Data Security

Levine Academy has established security policies to protect its computer environments. All employees granted access to the computers used by the school to conduct its business must be aware of and comply with these security standards and controls. Contact the System Administrator for the specific guidelines.

Most software used in Levine Academy's computer systems is subject to licensing agreements that govern its use. The use of unlicensed proprietary software and the misuse of licensed software are strictly prohibited. Computer security violations are a serious matter. Failure to follow the guidelines detailed in this policy will result in corrective action and/or termination of employment and possible legal action.

Password Security

Individual employee and student passwords and logins are required to operate computers and some of their programs. These passwords and logins are to be kept confidential and may not be shared with others. It is against school policy for an employee or student to let anyone else use their login or password for the network, e-mail or any other system. The only exception is on rare occasions when a member of the IT staff may need the login or password to access or troubleshoot a software or system problem.

Internet Access and Use

Internet use, on the school's time, is authorized to conduct school business only. Internet use brings the possibility of breaches to the security of confidential school information. Internet use also creates the possibility of contamination to our system via viruses or spyware. Spyware allows unauthorized people, outside the school, potential access to school passwords and other confidential information. Unauthorized access or "hacking" into the school's network or systems or misuse of these Web pages will result in corrective action, up to and including expulsion for students, termination for employees and possible legal action.

Email messages, Internet history and cookies, voicemail messages, documents created and stored on Levine Academy computers or Networks are the property of Levine Academy. Levine Academy reserves the right to access and monitor all files and messages on its systems.

Company Owns Equipment and Email

Keep in mind that Levine Academy owns any information within the Levine Academy network, hardware, communication sent via email or information stored on company equipment. Administrative staff members only have the right to access any material in your email or on your computer at any time. Approved authorization must be granted by the Head of School prior to accessing these things on a teacher's or administrator's computer. Please do not consider your electronic communication, storage or access to be private if it is created or stored on

work systems or within the school network. If you leave the school for any reason, Levine Academy will require that you return the equipment on your last day of work.

Levine Academy provides email addresses for its employees and uses email to communicate important school business information such as meeting notices, statutory and legal notices, company policies, and memos from the Head of School and other administrators. Each employee has the responsibility to read their email, including their Junk Email folder, as there are times when an email may fall into that folder and can go unnoticed if not periodically checked. If you do not have a Levine Academy email address, please notify your supervisor.

In all matters related to an employee's use of technology and accessing the school's network, adherence to the Acceptable Use Policy, which is spelled out in the "Staff Agreement and Application for Ann & Nate Levine Academy Electronic Communication / Data Management Systems," is required.

SECTION 4 COMPENSATION

Wage or Salary Increases

Each employee's hourly wage or annual salary will be reviewed on an annual basis. Such reviews may be conducted more frequently for a newly created position, or based on a recent promotion.

The school's ability to offer increases in compensation are dependent on the school's annual financial health, which may include meeting its enrollment goals for the upcoming school year; additional compensation factors may include performance, adherence to School policies and procedures, and ability to meet or exceed duties per job description and achieve performance goals (See Section 3.9, Performance Review/Planning Sessions). Levine Academy's salary ranges, hourly wage schedules, and faculty pay schedules will be adjusted on an ongoing basis in order for the school to keep pace, as best it can, with compensation levels in schools in our region that are of comparable profile and size.

Timekeeping

For employees receiving hourly pay, accurately recording time worked is the responsibility of the employee. Time worked is the time actually spent on a job(s) performing assigned duties.

Employee Work Schedules

Work schedules may vary by department and job responsibility. Student enrollment, scheduled and unscheduled activities and special events may also alter work schedules. The school reserves the right to modify an employee's starting and ending time as well as the number of hours worked to accommodate the school's needs.

Overtime

Levine Academy is open for business 40 hours per week. Overtime compensation is paid to non-exempt employees in accordance with federal and state wage and hour restrictions. Overtime is payable for all hours worked over 40 per week at a rate of one and one-half times the non-exempt employee's regular hourly rate. Time off on personal time, holidays, or any leave of absence will not be considered hours worked when calculating overtime. In addition, vacation time does not constitute hours worked. Employee's pay will be distributed through Direct Deposit at an appropriate financial institution of Employee's choice. Employees must make this selection when completing their employee packet.

SECTION 5

TIME OFF POLICIES

General Protocol

All regular and part-time salaried employees are eligible for paid holidays at the regular rate of pay for such employee. The School also has several procedures regarding paid and unpaid leaves of absence. The first section covers paid leaves of absence, which is followed by the section governing unpaid leaves of absence. The School will take seriously any disregard for these policies, including non-compliance of required procedures, misrepresentation of reasons for leave, using time off days for personal vacation during the school year, taking personal days during “black out” days, overuse of personal days, or assumptions about or the taking of time off without prior agreement between employee and school. Procedures for faculty absences when ill and arranging for substitutes are outlined in the section on “Faculty Absenteeism.”

Paid Holidays

All employees will be paid for the following holidays that fall on the employee’s regularly scheduled work days, but may be required to work based upon the needs of the School. The following paid holidays will be observed:

- New Year’s Day
- Martin Luther King Day
- Passover—for those days the school is scheduled to be closed
- Shavuoth—2 days
- Memorial Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Rosh Hashanah—2 days
- Yom Kippur
- Succot—2 days
- Shemini Atzeret
- Simchat Torah
- Thanksgiving—for those days the school is scheduled to be closed
- Winter Break—for those days the school is scheduled to be closed

For year-round employees, when Independence Day falls on a Saturday, the employee will receive the preceding Friday as paid leave; when it falls on a Sunday, the employee will receive the following Monday as paid leave. Employees will not be compensated for religious holidays that occur on a non-working day such as a weekend. Other listed holidays falling on a weekend will be paid only if the employee’s regular work schedule includes the holiday. Full-time and part-time teachers, teaching assistants and aides shall be entitled to holidays based on the School calendar. Where the School calendar differs from previously mentioned secular or religious holidays, the School calendar will prevail.

Time Off Policy

“Time Off” refers to both sick days and personal days. Personal days are not “vacation days,” and such requests will not be approved. Personal days are days the employee must take off for any number of non-medical personal

matters that may emerge that are unavoidable, that must be addressed, and/or that cannot be switched to another date when school is not in session. Personal days are also not an entitlement. These days are made available for your use in order to address personal business that is pressing and important to your well-being, so that you can return to school and resume teaching and working promptly with minimal stress. The process of pre-approval with your supervisor will necessitate mutual trust. Should the school learn later about the frivolous use of personal days, or about personal days taken that do not cohere with the original request, the school may exercise its right to retroactively deduct pay for such days taken.

- All full time teachers (30+ hours) and part time (20+ hours) will be allowed 8 paid sick days or personal days* during the 2021/2022 school year; part time teachers with less than 20 hours will be allowed 5 paid sick days or personal days during the school year.
- All personal days must be pre-approved by the Principal/Director and the HR Director in order to be paid; the school may seek verification for sick days taken within the allowable limits.
- Personal days must not be taken during “black out” dates, unless the personal day(s) fall under special circumstances, such as immediate family life cycle events like bar/bat mitzvah attendance and weddings, etc. Blackout dates: Regular personal leave may not be utilized during the first two weeks of school, the final two weeks of school, for the two days prior to Winter Break and Passover Break or two days following Winter Break or Passover Break, on the day before or the day after all other national or religious holidays, or to work at another job. Also, no more than two members of the teaching staff in a division (ECC or K8 divisions) may be on personal leave at the same time.
- There are other leave provisions that are spelled out in the Employee Manual, such as maternity leave, bereavement leave, and other leave provisions that may fall outside the standard allotment of paid time off.

Sick Days

Sick days may be used for any illness or any injury that inhibits an employee’s ability to perform his or her job effectively. Sick days also include when the employee needs time off for the care of a spouse, child, parent, parent-in-law, or grandparent who, because of illness or injury, needs supervision and/or treatment. Employees may not use sick days for scheduled appointments with doctors, dentists or other health care professionals if it is possible to schedule these appointments during non-work time. If health care appointments are scheduled during a work day, such time off will be accounted for as part of one’s Time Off allotment. An employee may be required to provide substantiation from a health care provider for the use of sick days, whether the sick days are for the employee or for the care of a spouse, dependent child, parent, parent-in-law, or grandparent. Sick days may not be used for purposes of vacation or personal business or for any reason other than the purpose for which it was intended.

Personal Days – regular and special

There are two categories of personal days, “regular” and “special” personal days. An employee may use any combination of these personal days in exhausting their allotment of time days off in a given school year; however, “regular” personal days may not be taken during “black out” periods of the school year, and these days are outlined in the third bullet point above, underneath Time Off Policy. Special personal day are outlined below:

A “special” personal day means a requested absence that is restricted to an important personal condition, situation, business, or family event which cannot be taken care of at any time other than during regular working hours; moreover, special personal days will also include events or emergencies which are beyond the employee’s control and cannot be anticipated. Examples of special personal days include 1) required court appearance; 2) sickness or absence not covered by the LOA policies outlined in the second section on Unpaid Leaves of Absence and for which the employee has a responsibility; 3) religious conferences for which the employee is an elected or appointed official and for which employee has a participating role at the event; 4) attendance at registration or graduation from college of spouse or children; 5) funeral of an immediate family member of the employee or his/her spouse’s family, or other relative or close friend not covered under the Unpaid Leave of Absence section;

6) attorneys and other legal matters of significant consequence which cannot be handled other than during the applicant's regular working hours; 7) personal financial affairs of significant consequences (e.g., home mortgage); 8) wedding of an immediate family member; 9) to accompany a child on a college visit for purpose of deciding which college the child will attend; 10) events of religious significance, such as a bar/bat mitzvah of an immediate family member or relative, when such attendance requires significant travel that intervenes on the school calendar days. Requests for special personal days should be provided to the Principal at least two weeks in advance of the planned absence for non-emergency situations; however, every effort should be made to notify the School as far in advance of the proposed absence as possible. If, in the School's judgment, the employee is negligent in forwarding a leave request in a timely manner for non-emergency situations, the School may determine the leave to be unpaid.

Regular Personal Days: Regular personal leave is personal leave utilized by the employee for personal reasons, including time off for community volunteering, and requested in accordance with the following guidelines:

- A statement requesting personal leave must be submitted to the Principal or Director at least three days in advance of the planned absence.
- If an emergency arises, the three (3) day advance notice provision may be waived upon notification to the Principal/Director of the emergency and his/her subsequent approval.
- The decision to grant the personal leave will include the School's determination on whether sufficient and appropriate coverage can be secured and whether the absence will not compromise the quality continuation of the School's daily operations.
- Regular personal leave may not be utilized during the first two weeks of school, the final two weeks of school, for the two days prior to Winter Break and Passover Break or two days following Winter Break or Passover Break, on the day before or the day after all other national or religious holidays, or to work at another job. Also, no more than two members of the teaching staff in a division (ECC or K8) may be on personal leave at the same time, unless such personal leave by one or more is deemed to be "special" as outlined above.
- Non-compliance with these procedures or the taking of regular personal days during the time frames outlined above will result in a payroll deduction equivalent to the employee's regular pay calculated for the duration of the absence. In addition, unwarranted and unapproved personal days can result in a poor performance review and may also lead to non-renewal of contract.

Any personal leave situation that falls outside the scope of the above explanations and procedures, such as the taking of vacation days, or the taking of sick days without verification when requested, or the taking of either sick or personal days beyond the allowable as outlined in the sections below, will not be paid for and will result in a payroll deduction equivalent to the employee's regular pay calculated for the duration of the absence.

Paid Leaves of Absence

Bereavement:

Paid bereavement leave of up to three (3) days will be granted when a death occurs in an employee's immediate family. Immediate family is defined as the parent, step-parent, spouse, child, step-child, brother, step-brother, sister, step-sister, grandchild or grandparent of the employee or employee's spouse.

In case of family members other than those listed above (aunts, uncles or first cousins), employees may take one (1) day of paid bereavement leave to attend the funeral (based on the employee's normal working hours).

Employees must notify their immediate supervisor immediately of the death and the dates of the employee's absence from work.

Paid bereavement for up to four (4) additional days may be granted (for immediate family only) to an employee in order to comply with an established religious practice or in extenuating circumstances. The decision to grant or deny a request for additional paid bereavement leave shall be within the discretion of the Head of School.

Bereavement leave in excess of that provided under this policy or leave for funerals of those not covered under this policy shall be governed by the provisions of the Paid Leave of Absence or the Unpaid Leave of Absence policies.

Jury Duty / Court Appearances:

From time to time, employees of Levine Academy may be called to participate in jury duty or other court appearances. Levine encourages participation of its employees in the legal process when called upon to so do, yet will also furnish letters of support should both the employee and the School agree that a request for duty postponement is warranted.

Levine Academy will compensate all employees at their regular rate of pay for jury duty during their normal working hours. The employee serving jury duty may retain any amount of daily compensation received from the court for their service. Employees must provide notice to their Principal (or to the Head of School, if an Administrator) at least one week prior to jury duty. Upon return to work, the employee must provide an attendance record from the court for each day of compensated jury duty.

Unpaid Leaves of Absence

The Head of School may grant an unpaid Leave of Absence (LOA), at his or her sole discretion, to assist an employee with an unusual circumstance. All Leaves of Absence shall be without pay.

- A. Any request for LOA must be in writing by the employee to his/her Principal/Director (or to the Head of School, if an Administrator). The LOA request should describe the reason for the LOA, the anticipated beginning and end dates and any other information that may be relevant to the evaluation of the leave request. The School will consider the following prior to giving approval:
 - Can arrangements be made for adequate coverage during the absence?
 - Are the reasons justified?
 - Does the employee's work performance and attendance record warrant the award of a LOA?
 - Has all applicable paid leave been exhausted?
 - Is the LOA in the best interest of the School?
- B. An approved Leave of Absence, in general, shall be for an amount of time in excess of an employee's allotted sick and personal days, but shall not exceed six (6) calendar months unless for military leave. The employment of any employee unable to return to work after the time granted for the LOA (for other than military leave) may be terminated.
- C. In all cases in which the need for leave is foreseeable, the employee should provide Levine Academy with 30 days of prior notice before the date the leave is to begin. Where circumstances beyond the employee's control make it impossible to give 30 days' notice, the employee should provide such notice to the School as soon as possible. In all cases in which the leave is foreseeable based on planned medical treatment of the employee or family member, the employee should make a reasonable effort to schedule the treatment so as not to disrupt unduly the operations of the School, subject to the approval of the health care provider of the employee or family member.
- D. If employee fails to give 30 days' notice for foreseeable leave with no reasonable excuse, the School may delay the start of the leave until 30 days after the date such notice is provided.

Family / Medical Leave of Absence (FMLA)

Under the Federal Family and Medical Leave Act (“FMLA”), eligible employees of Levine Academy may take up to twelve (12) weeks of unpaid leave during a calendar year for any of the following reasons:

- Birth of a child of the employee and care for the child within the first year following birth;
- The placement of a child with the employee for adoption or foster care within the first year of placement;
- The care of a spouse, child or parent who has a serious health condition;
- A serious health condition that makes the employee unable to perform the functions of his or her position.

Any accrued or owing paid leave accumulated by an employee will be counted against (substituted for) the amount of unpaid leave to which the employee is entitled under the FMLA.

Under FMLA, “Eligible Employee” means an employee who has been employed

- For at least 6 months by Levine Academy
- Has worked at least 625 hours with Levine Academy during the previous 6-month period.

Notice of the need for leave under this policy must be provided in writing to the Head of School. Medical certification, documentation and other required communications under this policy should be submitted to the Head of School.

Leaves Taken Intermittently or on a Reduced Leave Schedule

Leaves may not be taken on an intermittent or reduced leave schedule unless Levine Academy and the employee mutually agree and unless the leave is medically necessary.

The School may require that an employee transfer temporarily to an available alternative position for which the employee is qualified if the intermittent leave is foreseeable based on planned medical treatment. Such a transfer would be to a position that has equivalent pay and benefits and better accommodates recurring periods of leave than the regular employment position of the employee.

Certification of Serious Health Condition

All employees who request a leave of absence for a personal serious health condition or that of a family member must provide Levine Academy with written certification from the health care provider which supports their request for such leave. The certification should be provided, when possible, in advance of the leave and within 15 days from the date requested by the School unless it is not possible to do so despite the employee’s diligent, good faith efforts. Recertification of an employee’s or family member’s condition may be required on a reasonable basis.

Reporting while on Leave; Certification Required Upon Return to Work

If an employee takes a leave of absence because of his/her own serious health condition or to care for a family member with a serious health condition, the employee may be required to provide periodic updates of his/her status and intent to return to work.

Upon returning to work from a leave of absence for one’s own serious health condition, an employee will be required to provide certification from the employee’s health care provider that the employee is able to resume work.

Maintenance of Benefits During Leave

Coverage of the employee under Levine Academy's benefit plans will be continued for the duration of the employee's leave at the level and under the conditions that coverage would have been provided if the employee had continued in active employment continuously for the duration of the leave.

Employees will be required to continue making any required contributions or premiums to Levine Academy's group health plan during the term of the leave. If leave is unpaid, all premium payments should be submitted to the Business Office by the end of the month in order to be credited for the following month's coverage. If an employee's premium payment is more than 30 days late, Levine Academy's obligation to maintain health insurance coverage ceases. In the event the School elects to maintain health insurance coverage where the employee has become delinquent in his/her contributions, the School may recover from the employee his/her share of any premium payments missed by the employee during any family and medical leave upon expiration of the leave, whether or not the employee returns to work. Similarly, the School may recover from the employee his/her share of the premiums for non-health benefits maintained during the leave, upon expiration of the leave whether or not the employee returns to work.

Employees who fail to return to work promptly after the expiration of the leave for which they are eligible under this policy, for any reason other than the continuation, recurrence or onset of a serious health condition of the employee or of the employee's family member or other circumstances beyond the control of the employee or without obtaining the School's prior consent to prolong the period of leave, may be terminated and will be required to reimburse Levine Academy for its share of the premiums for maintaining coverage for the employee under the group health plan during any period of unpaid leave. The School may require certification from the health care provider in cases where the employee asserts that he/she is unable to return to work because of the continuation, recurrence, or onset of a serious health condition of the employee or a family member. The certification must state that a serious health condition prevents the employee from being able to perform the functions of his/her position as of the date that the leave granted under this policy expires or, in the case of a family member, that the employee is needed to care for such family member because of a serious health condition on the dates that the leave expires. Certification under these circumstances relates only to the employee's obligation to reimburse Levine Academy for the cost of maintaining coverage under the group health plan during leave, and neither this provision nor any other provision of this policy is to be construed as obligating the School to continue employment (or any benefits of employment) of any person who does not return to work, regardless of the reason, upon expiration of the leave authorized under this policy.

Employees do not accrue other employment benefits during the leave period.

Restoration to Prior Position

Upon the expiration of leave under the policy, the employee will be restored to the same position he/she held when the leave begins, or to an equivalent position, with equivalent employment benefits, pay and other terms and conditions of employment.

Modifications

This policy may be modified by Levine Academy at any time and is not intended to create legal rights or obligations beyond those existing under the Family and Medical Leave Act of 1993 or its amendment effective January 16, 2009 which updates the FMLA regulations to implement new military family leave entitlements under the National Defense Authorization Act for FY 2008.

Military Leave of Absence

A military LOA shall be granted to employees entering active duty in the US Armed Forces as a result of enforced military training or service or emergency active duty call-ups. Military LOA shall apply to enlistment only if the enlistment is for an initial tour of duty during a time of war or other military conflict involving the Armed Forces of the United States. An employee qualifying for military LOA shall not lower his seniority status.

Employees who serve in US military organizations or State militia groups may take the necessary time off without pay to fulfill the obligation, and will retain all of their legal rights for continued employment under existing laws. These employees may apply accrued personal leave and unused earned vacation time to the leave if they wish; however, they are not obliged to do so.

Such employees are expected to notify their supervisor as soon as possible of training dates and temporary emergency call-ups so that arrangements can be made for replacement during this absence if necessary.

Upon termination of the military service or training, an employee shall be reinstated by the School provided he/she reports for work within thirty (30) days of discharge.

SECTION 6 BENEFIT OVERVIEW

Levine Academy offers a benefits program for its regular full-time and regular part-time employees. However, the existence of these programs does not signify that an employee will necessarily be employed for the required time necessary to qualify for the benefits included in and administered through these programs.

In addition, please be aware that Texas law does not require an employer to participate in offering vacation, sick, parental, bereavement or personal leave; however, once it is offered, Texas law does require that it be followed as outlined in the Employee's Handbook. In addition, should an employer wish to offer any of the above listed leave policies, Texas law does not mandate whether or not that leave is to be a paid leave. Should the employer wish for their leave policies (some or all) to be paid, then Texas Payday Law will enforce any leave pay according to written policy outlined in the Employee's Handbook. Should you have any questions regarding the below leave policies, ask Human Resources for an explanation.

Your eligibility for each benefit program depends on a variety of factors, including your employee classification. While some of the benefit programs we offer may require you to contribute to the cost, many programs are fully paid by Levine Academy. Regular employees working more than 15 hours per week are eligible for many benefits. Some benefits, such as medical and dental insurance, are not available to employees working less than an average of 30 hours per week over a 52-week period.

You will find details about many of these programs elsewhere in the employee manual. In some cases, a policy may also refer you to other sources, such as the Summary Plan Document for that benefit. To better understand exactly which benefit programs you are eligible for, contact Human Resources.

The following benefit programs are available to eligible employees, subject to terms and conditions of each program:

- o Health Insurance Life Insurance
- o Short-Term Disability (includes Maternity Leave)
- o Long-Term Disability
- o Health Insurance Continuation (COBRA)
- o Retirement Plan (403b)
- o Flexible Spending Account (Section 125)
- o Vacation (Non-Teachers) Holiday Pay
- o Jury Duty and Court Leave Military Leave
- o Tuition Discount
- o Tuition Payments Through Payroll Deduction Professional Development
- o Educational Assistance Family & Medical Leave Personal Days (Teachers) Sick Days

Health Insurance

The health insurance plan at Levine Academy offers employees and their dependents access to medical and dental insurance benefits and vision care discounts. Regular full-time and part-time employees who work an average of 30 hours a week over 52 weeks are eligible to participate in this plan.

Eligible employees may participate in the health insurance plan subject to the terms and conditions of the agreement between Ann and Nate Levine Academy and the insurance carrier.

You will find details of the health insurance plan in the Summary Plan Description (SPD). When you become eligible, you will receive a SPD and rate information prior to the enrollment date. For questions about the Levine Academy health insurance plan, contact Human Resources.

Employees who regularly work 15 hours a week or more are eligible to participate in the school's group short and long term disability insurance and life insurance policies beginning the first day of employment. Details of the coverage are included in each plan's Summary Plan Document (SPD) which shall be provided to covered employees. Questions regarding these plans should be directed to Human Resources.

The employee's portion of the premium deduction for health insurance begins on the pay period prior to coverage start date.

This Manual does not contain the complete terms and/or conditions of any of Levine Academy's current insurance benefit plans. It is intended only to provide general explanations. If there is ever any conflict between the Manual and any documents issued by one of Levine Academy's insurance carriers, the carrier's guideline regulations will be regarded as authoritative.

Cobra Benefits

The Federal Consolidated Budget Reconciliation Act (COBRA) gives employees and their qualified beneficiaries the opportunity to continue health insurance coverage under the Levine Academy's health plan when a "qualifying event" would normally result in the loss of eligibility. Some common qualifying events are resignation, termination of employment, or death of an employee; a reduction in an employee's hours or leave of absence, divorce or legal separation and a dependent child no longer meeting eligibility requirements.

Under COBRA, the employee or beneficiary pays the full cost of coverage at Levine Academy's group rates plus an administration fee. Levine Academy provides each eligible employee with a written notice describing rights granted under COBRA when the employee becomes eligible for coverage under Levine Academy's health insurance plan. The notice contains important information about the employee's rights and obligations.

Social Security / Medicare

Levine Academy withholds income tax from all employees' earnings and participates in FICA (Social Security) and Medicare withholding and matching programs as required by law.

Retirement Savings Plan

Ann and Nate Levine Academy maintains a voluntary 403(b) retirement plan through TIAA/CREF for its employees. All employees are eligible to contribute to the plan from the date of their employment. Taxable income is reduced by the amount you contribute through salary deferral. At this time Levine does not currently match contribute to an employee's retirement plan. A complete Summary Plan Description with detailed information about the plan is available from Human Resources.

Flexible Spending Account (FSA)

Levine Academy provides a Flexible Spending Account (FSA) program that allows all employees (regardless of number of hours worked or full-time or part-time status) to have pre-tax dollars deducted from their salaries to pay for eligible out-of-pocket expenses. The pre-tax contributions made to the FSA can be used to pay for predictable non-reimbursed health care expenses and dependent care expenses during the plan year. Through the FSA program, you can reduce your taxable income without reducing your real income, so that you can keep more of the money you earn. An employee is eligible to participate in the FSA regardless of whether or not they take part in the company-offered health plan(s).

Participation in the Health Care and/or Dependent Care FSA is optional and determined on an annual basis for the plan year. You must enroll for each plan year. You determine how much to contribute to the account, up to a specified maximum, based on anticipated expenses during the plan year. You may contribute up to a maximum of \$2,750 each year for your Health Care FSA. For married couples filing a joint return, the maximum contribution for your Dependent Care FSA is \$10,500 per year; for single filers, the limit is \$5,250 per year. Contributions are directed to the FSA through salary reduction on a pre-tax basis. This tax-free money is then available to you for reimbursement of out-of-pocket expenses. Since the amounts that remain in the account at the end of the plan year are forfeited, you should take care not to over-fund your account.

Details of the Flexible Spending Account program are described in the Summary Plan Description (SPD). Contact Human Resources for more information on the Flexible Spending Account program and to obtain enrollment and reimbursement forms and worksheets with examples of reimbursable and non-reimbursable expenses.

SECTION 7 OTHER BENEFITS

Tuition Discount

Tuition discounts are available to all regular full-time and part-time Levine Academy employees who work and average of 15 hours a week or more. Employee children must meet the same student eligibility requirements as other Levine Academy students.

The tuition discount is 25% per child.

The tuition discount is available only during the existence of the employment relationship. Individuals hired on or after the beginning of the school's academic year are not automatically granted a tuition discount. The Head of School has the discretion, based upon existing budgetary considerations, to exclude such newly hired employee from the tuition discount program during that employee's first school year of employment.

Children in the policy mean biological children, legally adopted children, and step-child(ren) only if and while such step-child(ren) is in permanent residence in the home of the employee.

The tuition discount is not guaranteed but is a benefit subject to future review and possible revision by the School Board.

Employees are eligible to pay student tuition through payroll deduction as well as by standard payment methods. Those wishing to make payments in this manner should contact the Finance Department for a payroll

authorization form. Once this form is completed, it must be submitted to Human Resources in order for the payroll deduction to take effect.

Training and Professional Development

Levine Academy is committed to providing career and professional development opportunities to assist both academic and general staff to meet their personal, academic and/or professional needs in ways that are consistent with the objectives of the school. The principal aims are to develop skills and knowledge, optimize the quality of working life, and work towards excellence by supporting existing strengths and maximizing the potential contribution of all members of the staff.

Our accrediting institution, AdvancED, may also require that all professional personnel, including teachers and academic administrators, earn credits or clock hours of professional development activities such as workshops, seminars and conferences and other training activities. The Principal/Director will have this updated information each school year.

The overall responsibility for career planning rests with the individual. However, supervisors and department heads also have a vital role to play in career coaching and mentoring and in facilitating the professional development of their staff. Professional development planning, and the budget to meet planned requirements within available resources, must be an integral part of the school's business planning processes.

Each year, as part of the annual performance review cycle, individuals and their supervisors are expected to identify professional developmental opportunities. Together they should plan for this development using internal mentoring, outside developmental seminars or through school sponsored learning opportunities.

Authorization of payment for the cost of outside seminars, consultants, materials and other developmental related costs must be approved, in advance and in writing, by the employee's supervisor. This authorization and related expense receipts and/or invoices must be submitted to the Business Office for payment. Employees who are authorized to attend seminars or conferences under this policy will continue to receive their normal pay. Employees should submit a copy of any certificates received to Human Resources for inclusion in their personnel file.

Educational Assistance

The school will consider partially underwriting one's study at colleges and universities in the Dallas area. Employees who receive a grade of "B" or higher may be reimbursed \$100 per course, approved by the Head of School. If the course taken has a direct relevance to one's current teaching assignments or position responsibilities, in the judgment of the Head of School, the reimbursed amount may be higher, depending on the school's available professional development resources. To receive this reimbursement, employees must obtain advance approval from their supervisor and submit a transcript with the request for reimbursement to the business office at the end of the semester.

SECTION 8 SCHOOL SAFETY & SECURITY POLICIES & PROCEDURES

Safety

Levine Academy provides information to employees about workplace safety and health issues through regular internal communication such as:

Each employee is expected to obey safety rules and exercise caution and common sense in all work activities. Employees must immediately report any unsafe conditions to their supervisor. Employees who violate safety standards, cause hazardous or dangerous situations, or fail to report, or where appropriate, remedy such situations, may be subject to disciplinary action including termination of employment.

In the case of an accident that results in injury, regardless of how insignificant the injury may appear, employees should notify their supervisor or Human Resources.

Inclement Weather / Emergency Closings

Circumstances that may require emergency closing of the school include inclement weather, natural disaster, fire, and utility failure, local or regional public emergency or other forced evacuation.

The Head of School is responsible for making the final decision to close the school. Once this decision is made the Director of Communications will deliver a message via the school's mass texting service to all employees and families. In the case of crisis, the school's crisis management procedures will be followed.

Status of the closing and information about reopening will be communicated via mass texting and email, and Levine Academy's Website.

EMERGENCY DRILLS CRISIS MANAGEMENT

Regular emergency drills are required by state law and local ordinance and are an important safety precaution at Levine Academy. Evacuation procedure maps are located in each classroom and are also strategically placed throughout the facility as a reference for students, school employees and visitors.

Regular drills are an important part of preparing for the possibility of a fire, tornado or other emergency at the school. These drills help prepare and educate students and staff alike so that everyone will know what to do and where to go in the case of a real emergency. State or local law requires that fire drills be conducted regularly during the school year and that records of these drills be kept by school administration.

Emergency drills may be announced in advance or they may be unannounced. In either case, teachers, administrators and staff should follow school procedures to evacuate the building and/or relocate all building occupants to safe areas. Teachers are required to take their class rosters with them during any emergency drill for the purpose of taking roll and ensuring that all children are with the class.

CRISIS MANAGEMENT PLAN

Ann and Nate Levine Academy takes its responsibility to the community seriously. We have developed a crisis management plan that will be instituted should any crisis related to military action or terrorist activity or any other significant emergency occur during the school day. Responses to such activities depend upon two key variables; 1) the nature of the act itself and 2) the amount of warning time involved.

Role of the Incident Commander

The Head of School serves as the Incident Commander. In the absence of the Head of School, the K8 Principal will serve as Incident Commander. The Commander shall direct the school's response during a time of crisis. Responsibilities include overseeing the daily life of the school, chairing all meetings of the crisis team, keeping the Information Center updated, chairing the evaluation process, and submitting final reports to the Crisis Team.

Role of the Crisis Team

The role of the Crisis Team is to assess the crisis and generate a plan that meets the emotional and academic needs of the school community via the coordination of counseling services and the alteration of the academic schedule.

Information Center

The role of the Information Center is two-fold: (1) provide a suitable location on campus where parents may receive up-to-date information about the crisis and revisions in the academic schedule and/or calendar and (2) disseminate crisis information to appropriate constituents through the phone team or written notice, as determined by the Crisis Team (see appendix). The Information Center is coordinated by the Head of School. All media will be denied access to the Information Center and directed to the Campus Media Spokesperson.

Counseling

The Crisis Management Team will coordinate all on-campus counseling.

Levine Academy does not disclose information pertaining to any member of the school community to the media and strongly discourages any member of the school community from doing so. This policy includes all employees of Levine Academy. Media will not be permitted on campus during a crisis period. The Incident Commander and any attending law enforcement personnel will decide whether media presence is warranted or appropriate, at what time, and in what specific location. At the appropriate time the school will submit a press release.

Attendance

If a parent chooses to keep a child at home due to a school crisis, the school office must be notified as in any regular absence. All make-up work is to be completed as outlined in the Parent Handbook.

Students Leaving Campus

Students will not be permitted to leave campus without parental consent during a crisis period.

Crisis Management Team

- Head of School
- K8 Principal
- Director of EC
- Director of Jewish Life and Learning
- Director of Human Resources
- Director of Finance and Operations
- Director of Marketing and Communications

Additional members of the team are determined by the nature of the crisis.

In the event of a crisis situation, the Crisis Management Team will communicate with the following constituents, as appropriate.

- Students
- Parents
- Faculty and Staff

- Board of Directors
- Alumni
- Friends of the school
- Neighbors of the school
- Other schools in the area
- Jewish Federation of Greater Dallas
- Media
- General Public
- School Community

RESPONSE PROTOCOL

A Level One Crisis is a personal tragedy or threatening incident primarily affecting a single member or family in the school community. Examples include death of a parent, guardian, or other significant family member; suicide threat; rumor of highly contagious disease; violent behavior of a student or staff member; or assault on a student, teacher or staff member.

A Level Two crisis may be defined as a major personal crisis, threatening incident, or major disaster that indirectly impacts the school. Examples include accusation of school personnel being involved in illegal activity; accident resulting in severe injuries to several people; suicide attempt off-campus; or national incidents such as political assassination or war.

A Level Three crisis may be defined as a crisis that has a direct and profound impact on the school community. Examples include death of a student or teacher, natural disaster, suicide at school, cluster suicides, community epidemic, taking of hostages, or terrorists' acts. All levels will have the same response protocol as follows:

- Incident Commander or Administration identifies and verifies crisis.
- Incident Commander notifies and schedules meeting of Crisis Team.
- Crisis Team plans immediate response and prepares faculty statement.
- Crisis Team notifies faculty & staff by mass text and email, or in some circumstances via face-to-face communication in a stand-up meeting, explaining the crisis and their role in the plan.
- Incident Commander activates Information Center.
- Incident Commander contacts appropriate staff members and arranges security.
- Crisis Team generates prepared statement and plans for status of school, such as closure, or re-opening.
- Crisis Team assesses counseling needs of school community.
- Incident Commander schedules a meeting to evaluate the current plan, discuss new information, and plan for any additional action or revisions.
- Communications from school officials to faculty/staff continue as necessary and to the greater community as necessary, with updated information.
- Faculty and Students follow schedule prepared by Crisis Team.
- Crisis Team reconvenes and plans for additional action or revisions.
- Incident Commander schedules an evaluation meeting.
- Incident Commander submits a report to Crisis Team.

CRISIS RESPONSE LEVELS

The following are summaries of action plans that will be followed in specific situations. All staff, faculty and students will be expected to follow these guidelines.

Situation 1: Military action (war) limited to the Middle East

1. Maintain normal school activity
2. Heighten campus security

Situation 2: Terrorist action in the United States

1. Maintain normal school activity
2. Heighten campus security
3. Restrict campus access
4. Suspend off-campus student privileges
5. Allow students to leave campus with parental permission only
6. Make decisions regarding extra-curricular activities

Situation 3: Terrorist action in the Dallas – Ft. Worth Metroplex area

1. Maintain normal school activity
2. Heighten campus security
3. Restrict campus access
4. Suspend off-campus student privileges
5. Allow students to leave campus with parental permission only
6. Make decisions regarding after school and extra-curricular activities
7. Be prepared to lock down campus
8. In the event the campus evacuation is ordered, students will be instructed to assemble via the standard fire drill procedure and will be escorted to the designated nearby disaster center.

Situation 4: Terrorist action in the Dallas area involving biological or chemical weapons

1. Lock down campus immediately
2. Suspend classes, seal and lock down classes and buildings (students may be directed to the gymnasium)
3. Shut off all HVAC units immediately
4. Suspend all off-campus privileges
5. Allow student to leave with parental permission only
6. Suspend all extra-curricular activities

Preparation

1. The school has on hand stored amounts of food and water, first aid kits and battery-powered radios and lights
2. Parents are encouraged to supply back-up medication(s) for storage

Blood borne Pathogen Exposure Policy

Ann and Nate Levine Academy is concerned about employees who may be exposed to blood and other bodily fluids when rendering first aid. The school has a written Blood borne Pathogen Exposure and Control Plan in place. It includes information regarding who is identified as being at risk, Hepatitis B vaccines, training and recordkeeping. This plan is reviewed with all employees who are in positions that have been identified at risk of exposure to Blood borne pathogens. The following is a summary of procedures to follow when first aid or cleanup of fluids becomes necessary.

Any materials, including latex gloves and CPR Micro-Shields, used in administering first aid should be discarded in the red biohazard bags located in the School Nurse's Office and the aid procedure. If there is exposure to Hepatitis B at the school, medical treatment and vaccine will be offered at no cost to the employee. The red biohazard bags will be picked up by special arrangement with the local waste management company on a regular basis. Employees who have questions about this policy should contact the School Nurse for more information.

Child Abuse and Sexual Molestation Prevention & Reporting

The safety and well-being of children is a serious concern for educators and schools. Ann and Nate Levine Academy's policy is that all faculty, administrators and staff share the responsibility of the prevention and reporting of suspected child abuse and sexual molestation. The school intends to comply with the provisions of the laws of the State of Texas and the guidelines established by the Texas Department of Family and Protective Services.

Employment

Ann and Nate Levine Academy will not knowingly employ anyone who has been convicted of child abuse or sexual molestation. The school requires as part of its employment process a background check be conducted on all applicants before an offer of employment is extended. Periodic follow-up background checks are also conducted as part of continuing employment.

Molestation Prevention at School

Levine Academy expects all employees to limit the opportunities for molestation, responding quickly and appropriately to suspicious situations and taking actions or making reports when warranted. The school reserves the right to investigate employee or volunteer misconduct even if no complaint has been made. Employees are expected to adhere to the following guidelines of behavior:

Limit occasions of being alone with a child and be suspicious of anyone who is. Whenever possible have another teacher or adult present or be in an open, public area. If being alone with a child is the only option, be sure the door to the room is kept open.

- Monitor volunteers and visitors to ensure they are never alone with a child.
- Report any known misconduct or questionable behavior on the part of fellow employees, volunteers, visitors and students.
- The school prohibits consensual sexual relationships between an employee and volunteer and students, including students who have reached the age of consent.

Monitoring and Surveillance Policy

Levine Academy may conduct workplace monitoring to help ensure employee and student safety and security. The computer equipment and systems and Internet access that employees may use are always the property of Levine Academy. Therefore, we reserve the right to monitor computer activities. We also reserve the right to retrieve and read any computer files or data that are composed, sent, or received through Internet connections or stored in our computer systems.

We may conduct video surveillance of non-private workplace areas. We use video monitoring to identify safety concerns, maintain security, detect theft and misconduct, and discourage and prevent acts of harassment and violence. Because we are sensitive to the legitimate privacy rights of our employees, students, and visitors we will make every effort to guarantee that workplace monitoring is always done in an ethical and respectful manner.

Security Inspections and Searches

Access to Levine Academy premises is conditioned upon its right to inspect or search the person, vehicle, or personal effects of any employee or visitor. This may include any employee's office, desk, file cabinet, closet, locker, or similar place. Employee participation in the search procedure is a condition of continued employment and failure to cooperate in a search or investigation can lead to termination. Because even a routine inspection or search might result in the viewing of an employee's personal possessions, employees are encouraged not to bring any item of personal property to the workplace that they do not want revealed to the school.

Vehicles, desks and lockers may be provided for the convenience of employees but remains the sole property of the school. Unauthorized storage of school property in desks and lockers is not permitted. Only school provided locks may be used to secure desks and lockers.

Any prohibited materials (or materials that may be found to be prohibited) that are found in an employee's possession during an inspection or search will be collected and placed in a sealed container or envelope.

The employee's name, date, circumstances under which the materials were collected, and by whom they were collected will be recorded and attached to the container or written on the envelope. If after further investigation, the collected materials prove not to be prohibited, they will be returned to the employee, and the employee will sign a receipt for the contents. If the prohibited materials prove to be illegal and/or dangerous, they will not be returned to the employee but will be turned over to the appropriate law enforcement agency.

From time to time, and without prior announcement, inspections or searches may be made of anyone entering, leaving, or on the premises or property of the school (including alcohol and/or drug screens or other testing). Refusal to cooperate in such an inspection or search (including alcohol and/or drug screens) is grounds for corrective action up to and including termination of employment.

Use of School Property and Equipment

Certain job positions allow for the personal assignment of school property and/or equipment. This assignment may be on temporary or recurring basis or may be assigned to the employee during the term of his/her employment. Employees are required to follow proper procedures and instructions for care and maintenance of the property in their possession. They are also expected to return assigned property to the school when requested and/or at the end of their employment. Failure to return property when requested or at the end of employment may result in corrective action, deduction of the value from wages, or billing for the amount owed.

Violence Protection

The safety and security of all students and employees is of primary importance at Levine Academy. Threats, threatening and abusive behavior, or acts of violence against employees, students, parents, visitors, or other individuals by anyone on school property or at school functions will not be tolerated. Violations of this policy will lead to corrective action up to, and including, termination and/or referral to appropriate law enforcement agencies for arrest and prosecution. The school reserves the right to take any necessary legal action to protect its employees.

Any person who makes threats, exhibits threatening behavior, or engages in violent acts on school premises shall be removed from the premises as quickly as safety permits and shall remain off school premises pending the outcome of an investigation. Following investigation, the school will initiate an immediate and appropriate response. This response may include, but is not limited to, suspension and/or termination of any business relationship, reassignment of job duties, suspension or termination of employment, and/or criminal prosecution of the person or persons involved.

All employees are responsible for notifying their supervisor, Human Resources or the Head of School of any threats that they witness or receive or that they are told another person witnessed or received. Even without a specific threat, all employees should report any behavior or situation they have witnessed that they regard potentially threatening or violent or which could endanger the health or safety of an employee when the behavior has been carried out on a school-controlled site or is connected to school employment or school business. Employees are responsible for making this report regardless of the relationship between the individual who initiated the threatening behavior and the person or persons being threatened. The school understands the

sensitivity of the information requested and has developed confidentiality procedures that recognize and respect the privacy of the reporting employee.

Weapons

Despite some laws (Concealed Handgun License, CHL) that allow people to carry firearms in public, Ann and Nate Levine Academy prohibits anyone from possessing or carrying weapons of any kind on school property, in school vehicles, or personal vehicles at any school function on or off campus or while on school business. This includes:

1. Any form of weapon or explosive; All firearms; and
2. All illegal knives or knives with blades that are more than six inches in length.

If an employee is unsure whether an item is covered by this policy, he/she should contact Human Resources. Employees are responsible for making sure that any item they possess is not prohibited by this policy. Police officers, security guards, and other individuals who have been given consent by the school to carry a weapon on the property will be allowed to do so. While the school has a policy prohibiting weapons, nothing in this policy shall be construed as creating any duty or obligation on the part of the school to take any actions beyond those required of an employer by existing law.